



HOST GUIDE / The Last Acquisition

Your role

Host a museum gala and lead the investigation into Grant Larceny's death. You can play too: the murderer is chosen by a secret memorized animal draw, and this guide reveals no character's private branch.

Object of the game

Identify the murderer by weighing the discoveries, motives and conflicting testimony. Everyone has a scandal; a scandal alone does not prove murder. Every question, answer, hunt hint, ballot and Coming Clean speech is in the player's packet.

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Party details

October 30, 2026 / 1537 S 74th East Ave, Tulsa, OK 74112. Plan 6:00 arrival to 9:30 finish. Assign the first 15 roles before adding more guests. Every attending character can be the murderer.



Preparation checklist

One week before

- Assign character names and send each guest only their public introduction PDF or JPEG and invitation.
- Ask guests to remember their character names. Nobody needs a character number or a partner. Costume ideas are optional.
- Read this guide and choose who will deliver the investigation announcements. If playing, keep private packet pages and organizer sources unread.
- Choose rooms for the museum labels and print one complete packet per attending guest.

Before guests arrive

- Keep ballot page 11 loose inside; staple the other pages in order. Add a pencil and named place card.
- Print the host name checklist. Put the five reports F1-F5 in order in a host folder.
- Hide Discoveries 1-16 using page 8. Set an Evidence Table.
- Prepare Player Bowl A and matching Murderer Bowl B using all 30 familiar animals, plus one closed return box.
- Lower the music for questioning. Guests may sit anywhere; no partner assignment is needed.



Materials and copy counts

Item	Copies / purpose
Complete twelve-page packet	One per attending guest; questions, records, ballot and Coming Clean included
Host guide and name checklist	One each
Public introduction PDF or JPEG	One sent to each guest before the party
F1-F5 investigation reports	One staged set, read aloud and displayed
Discoveries 1-16	Sixteen full-page records; fold each page for its numbered envelope
Animal draw cards	Two matching sets of 30 animals
Containers	Bowl A, matching Bowl B, closed return box
Place cards, signs, exhibits, awards	One set as needed
Pencils	One per guest; spares

Printing

Single-sided, Actual size / 100%. Staple all except loose ballot page 11. No font installation is needed. Use a non-playing helper if your printer exposes private text. No player question catalog, evidence-letter cards or finale envelopes are required.



Character directory

Assign by personality

Assign the first fifteen names before adding the remaining roles. Names are how guests choose questions and vote. Animals are drawn privately at arrival; every attending role is eligible.

Artie Ficial	Executive Director of the Meridian Museum
Claire O'Scuro	Chief Curator of World Cultures
Hugh Bidder	International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison
Monet Bags	Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum
Chip Patina	Chief Conservator
Dada DiCapo	Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity
Vincent Van Faux	Celebrated Contemporary Painter
Sue Venir	Cultural Property Attorney
Dr. Art E. Fact	Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar
Tess Tament	Philanthropist & Heir to the Larceny Family Fortune
Barb Dwyer	Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator
Paige Turner	Investigative Arts Journalist
Frank Lloyd Wrong	Exhibition Architect & Designer
Mona Lott	International Cultural Heritage Envoy
Elon Mosaic	Tech Founder, Collector & Museum Patron



Character directory

Assign by personality

Assign the first fifteen names before adding the remaining roles. Names are how guests choose questions and vote. Animals are drawn privately at arrival; every attending role is eligible.

Anya Tique	Founding Curator Emerita
Saul D. Bid	Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House
Elle Loominate	Textile Artist & Designer
Reed DeLabel	Doctoral Fellow in Art History
Al Baster	Sculptor & Public-Art Star
Ella Gance	Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture
Drew Conclusions	Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster
Brie DeVivre	Head Caterer & Hospitality Director
Cary Crates	Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist
Anne E. Dote	Director of Education & Docent Programs
Faye Stop	Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist
Robin Banks	Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer
Penny Pincher	Eccentric Private Collector
Justin Tyme	Tulsa Arts Columnist & Local Historian
Minnie Malist	Gala Event Designer & Creative Producer



Memorized animal assignment

At arrival

- Each guest draws one animal from Bowl A, reads silently, memorizes it, folds the slip and immediately returns it to the closed box. Nobody keeps or shows a slip.
- Draw only from Bowl A. Never put returned slips back into A during arrivals.
- When all expected guests have drawn, remove from matching Bowl B every unused animal left in A. B now contains exactly the animals memorized by attending guests.
- There is no optional bowl and no name-to-animal list. Keep B separate from the closed return box.

Before Act I: Motive

Before Act I: Motive, ask everyone to keep a blank face. Draw one animal from Bowl B and announce it twice. Its owner uses IF MURDERER in all three acts and Coming Clean; everyone else uses IF INNOCENT. Keep the selected animal in the host folder. Do not identify its owner.

Late arrivals

A guest arriving after selection may draw an unused A animal and join as innocent: that animal was excluded from B. Before selection, simply include their draw in the normal attendance process.



Print and assemble complete packets

Safe covers on the seats

- Print one named twelve-page SECRET packet per attending guest, single-sided at 100%. The ornate first page contains only the portrait and name: packets may face up on assigned seats.
- Leave ballot page 11 loose inside. Staple the other pages in order. A helper can assemble private pages face down.
- Pages 1–3: cover, public orientation and private briefing. Page 4: hunt. Pages 5–6: Motive. Pages 7–8: Opportunity. Pages 9–10: Method. Page 11: ballot. Page 12: Coming Clean.
- Each act has one question page followed by its answer page. Stop signs mark the end of each section.

Combined printing

Each consecutive twelve-page block belongs to one character. Follow the cover names and public assembly sheet. The covers are safe; interior sheets contain private information.

Host folder

Stage F1–F2 before Motive, F3 before Opportunity, F4–F5 before Method. Put numbered Discoveries 1–16 in separate envelopes, using the placement list on page 8. Keep the spoiler bible closed if you are playing.



House hunt / sixteen envelopes

Number the envelopes 1–16 and use these exact hiding places. Each packet has three cryptic hints. Put the garage-door clue where a helper can safely hand it down; guests must not climb.

- | | |
|----|--------------------------------|
| 1 | behind the television |
| 2 | inside the Bohoeffer biography |
| 3 | under a metal chair |
| 4 | on top of a mirror |
| 5 | under a musical keyboard |
| 6 | under a trophy |
| 7 | inside a vase |
| 8 | inside a cupboard |
| 9 | behind a painting |
| 10 | on top of a map of Barcelona |
| 11 | behind red curtains |
| 12 | near a green lamp |
| 13 | above the garage door |
| 14 | inside a Bible |
| 15 | behind a blue cushion |
| 16 | inside the freezer |

At the end of the hunt, count all 16 discoveries at the Evidence Table. Fetch any missing envelopes and share their contents before the investigation. Record the actual finder for Curator's Eye; a missing clue never blocks the case.



Evening agenda

6:00–6:20	Arrival / memorize and return animals
6:20–6:35	Introductions / pages 2–3
6:35–7:00	Hunt / page 4; share all 16 discoveries
7:00–7:10	Buffet / gather and announce the death
7:10–7:35	Select animal, then Act I: Motive / F1–F2 / pages 5–6
7:35–8:05	Act II: Opportunity / F3 / pages 7–8
8:05–8:35	Act III: Method / F4–F5 / pages 9–10
8:35–8:50	Open discussion / revisit evidence
8:50–9:00	Accusations / loose ballot page 11
9:00–9:20	Coming Clean / page 12
9:20–9:30	Awards / dessert / debrief

Keep the group moving

These are planning allowances, not measured performance times. Read one question and one answer per guest per round. With 30 guests, avoid extra speeches until everyone has answered. Pause for a short discussion after each round.



Introductions and hunt

Say aloud

Welcome to the Meridian Museum gala. Open your orientation and briefing on pages 2–3. When called, introduce yourself by reading the introduction box. Keep private pages facing you.

Introductions

- Hear each guest once. They may use their character's voice or simply read.
- Allow mingling with the private conversation prompts. An absent target never blocks play.
- Then announce: Open HUNT FOR CLUES, page 4. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden. Follow your three hints; you may help one another. Bring finds to the Evidence Table and share them.

Before the death

- Count and display all 16 discoveries. Fetch any missed envelope. Keep documents available for everyone to reread.
- Gather everyone where they can hear. Turn down the music. Announce Grant's death, select and announce the murderer animal using page 6 of this guide, then begin Motive.
- Read only the current section. Coming Clean opens after every ballot is locked.



ACT I: MOTIVE

Release and announce

First select and announce the murderer animal using page 6 of this guide. Keep its owner secret. Then read and display F1-F2. Say: Open Motive. Questions are on page 5; answers on page 6. Use IF MURDERER if the animal matches yours, otherwise IF INNOCENT. Read only the bordered words.

Run the question chain

- Choose an attending guest. Ask the printed question beside their name.
- After answering, that guest chooses an unheard attending guest from the question page. Skip absent names.
- Tick the speaker on the host roster. Every attending guest answers once, including the person who started.
- If the chain stalls, name an unheard guest and ask their printed question. No seating order or partners are needed.
- When all have spoken, allow a short discussion and repeats. Keep the documents visible. Do not supply an interpretation of the evidence.

Close the act

Tell everyone to stop at the red sign. Keep the same selected animal and the same innocent/murderer branch for the remaining acts. Never redraw between rounds.



ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Release and announce

Read and display F3. Say: Open Opportunity. The questions are on page 7; your answer is on page 8. Choose by character name. Read only the words inside your speaking box.

Run the question chain

- Choose an attending guest. Ask the printed question beside their name.
- After answering, that guest chooses an unheard attending guest from the question page. Skip absent names.
- Tick the speaker on the host roster. Every attending guest answers once, including the person who started.
- If the chain stalls, name an unheard guest and ask their printed question. No seating order or partners are needed.
- When all have spoken, allow a short discussion and repeats. Keep the documents visible. Do not supply an interpretation of the evidence.

Close the act

Tell everyone to stop at the red sign. Announce the next section only when the room is ready.



ACT III: METHOD

Release and announce

Read and display F4-F5. Say: Open Method. The questions are on page 9; your answer is on page 10. Choose by character name. Read only the words inside your speaking box.

Run the question chain

- Choose an attending guest. Ask the printed question beside their name.
- After answering, that guest chooses an unheard attending guest from the question page. Skip absent names.
- Tick the speaker on the host roster. Every attending guest answers once, including the person who started.
- If the chain stalls, name an unheard guest and ask their printed question. No seating order or partners are needed.
- When all have spoken, allow a short discussion and repeats. Keep the documents visible. Do not supply an interpretation of the evidence.

Close the act

Tell everyone to stop at the red sign. Announce the next section only when the room is ready.



Voting and Coming Clean

Say: Open ACCUSATIONS, page 11. Choose one attending guest and explain your strongest evidence. Fold and hand in only the loose ballot. Keep your packet. No votes change once all ballots are collected.

Collect and lock ballots

- Complete loose page 11 privately: suspect, motive, evidence and awards. The murderer votes too. Fold writing inward and hand over only the ballot. Keep the packet for Coming Clean.
- Collect one ballot per attending guest. Use the checklist's tally page; confirm collected equals attending before any Coming Clean page opens. No votes change.
- Give every attending character a total, including zero. Select the three highest totals among attendees. Break ties alphabetically by full character name. Zero-vote ties fill remaining places, so three guests still resolve their secrets after a unanimous vote.
- Read the three names in descending vote order. Each reads only their IF INNOCENT or IF MURDERER Coming Clean box on page 12. Hear all three, even if the first confesses.

If nobody confesses

Say: The murderer is not among our three suspects. Whoever memorized [selected animal], please stand and read your IF MURDERER Coming Clean confession. Do not call the animal if one of the three already confessed.

Award and finish

Master Sleuth: an innocent guest who names the murderer and supports the accusation with a coherent motive and evidence. Share equally strong detective awards. Escaped Justice: murderer outside the top three. Ballot votes decide Best Actor and Best Costume; discovery tally decides Curator's Eye.



Quick cues and troubleshooting

Round cues

Introductions	Pages 2–3 / each introduction box / private social prompts
Hunt	Page 4 / retrieve and share all sixteen discoveries
Motive	F1–F2 / questions 5, answer 6 / hear everyone once
Select	Before Motive / exclude unused A animals from B / announce twice; keep the same branch for all acts
Opportunity	F3 / questions 7, answer 8 / hear everyone once
Method	F4–F5 / questions 9, answer 10 / hear everyone once
Accusations	Loose page 11 / collect every ballot / lock all votes
Coming Clean	Page 12 / hear all top three / animal fallback only if none confesses

Recovery

- Missing discovery: fetch it before investigation. A guest who cannot search can read finds or ask a helper to follow their hints.
- Forgotten animal before selection: restart everyone's draw. After selection: pause; never guess the murderer. Restart together, or postpone scoring.
- Absent guest: skip their name; exclude their unused animal from B. A late arrival after selection joins as innocent.
- Repeated target or stalled chain: ask an unheard attending guest using the printed questions. Tick every speaker on the roster.
- Reading ahead: stop and return to the current round. Coming Clean opens only after ballots are collected.
- Missing packet page: replace the complete named packet, never a standalone branch.